

	BeReal				Competitor			
Theme	Feature	Theme Score	Reason for the Score	Insights	Feature	Theme Score	Reason for the Score	Insights
Engagement	Daily Shared Moment & Habit - "Me and my friends absolutely love it and look forward to BeReal time every day."	11	Moderately frequent, with strong positive sentiment because users look forward to the daily moment and participate with friends, supporting the recurring habit.	BeReal's engagement is a more social experience which is driven by the recurring shared moment with friends.	Reach & Discoverability - "Reels serve as a powerful tool for expanding reach."	13	Very frequent, with strong positive outcomes such as views and follower growth, although some users report inconsistent growth. Its high frequency and intensity makes it a major engagement driver.	Reels has a stronger overall engagement because they generate reach, discovery and follower growth, but it is more growth-focused than habit-focused.
Content Creation	Strict 2-minute Window - "I've missed so many on-time BeReals by just 3 minutes."	9	Mixed sentiment because users intensely express frustration over time pressure when posting although they value the constraint for spontaneity.	BeReal's time window creates a distinct type of participation where authenticity comes from limited preparation but avoidable time pressure should be reduced.	Trial Reels Experimentation - "This approach allows it to expand its reach while keeping my main feed unaffected."	10	Positive driver but less frequently mentioned and intensely expressed. Users value low-risk experimentation and testing content, although the theme is less prominent.	Instagram makes experimentation with content easier by separating testing from exposing content to the existing audience.
Creation Friction	Posting Reliability Within the 2-minute Window - "Within the two minutes I have to post, I have to close the app multiple times for the camera load which wastes time as the timer ticks."	8	Less frequent negative barrier, but strongly expressed frustration because the camera, upload or app failures prevent users from posting within the time limit.	BeReal's friction can cause users to miss posting within the time limit, so camera, loading and uploading reliability must be prioritised.	Creation & Editing Friction - "Adjusting the placement and timing of text is incredibly frustrating."	8	Less frequent friction but intensity of frustration is high because glitches and difficult editing make content creation harder.	Editing tools gives users creative control but can also cause friction that comes from complex editing.

Content Value	Spontaneity & Authenticity - "The two-minute posting window encourages spontaneous posts."	12	One of BeReal's most frequent positive themes because users value the spontaneous, authentic content, supporting the product's core value.	BeReal has the stronger positive response because of the authentic content, giving it an emotional advantage over Instagram's reach-focused experience.	Recommendation Relevance - "Reels keep showing me content I've marked as 'not interested,' repeat content, content in foreign languages, and crap I'm absolutely not interested in."	9	Moderately mentioned, highly negative theme expressed with strong frustration because of irrelevant or repetitive recommendations.	Instagram's recommendation problems show that high content volume and reach do not automatically mean satisfying content experience.
Feature Exposure	Notification Reliability - "Notifications started arriving late—usually by 2 to 4 minutes."	10	Strongly negative and frequently mentioned with high intensity because delayed or missing notifications disrupt the daily habit and prevent users from accessing the feature when intended.	BeReal's challenge is under-delivery and not overexposure so users may want to participate but do not receive the feature reliably. Making the notifications consistent and timely can make users participate without weakening the spontaneity feature.	Reels Intrusiveness - "The emphasis on reels has reached an extreme, effectively sidelining carousels and static content."	8	Strongly negative because users intensely dislike the forced exposure of Reels, especially when they disrupt the users' preferred content experience.	Instagram faces the opposite problem because users find Reels too intrusive. This shows the importance of balancing feature visibility with user control.